

# Plebs vs Pirates

The plebs came together to have a drink  
As they knew freedom was on the brink  
But after pirates comes a tank  
So never keep your keys at a bank



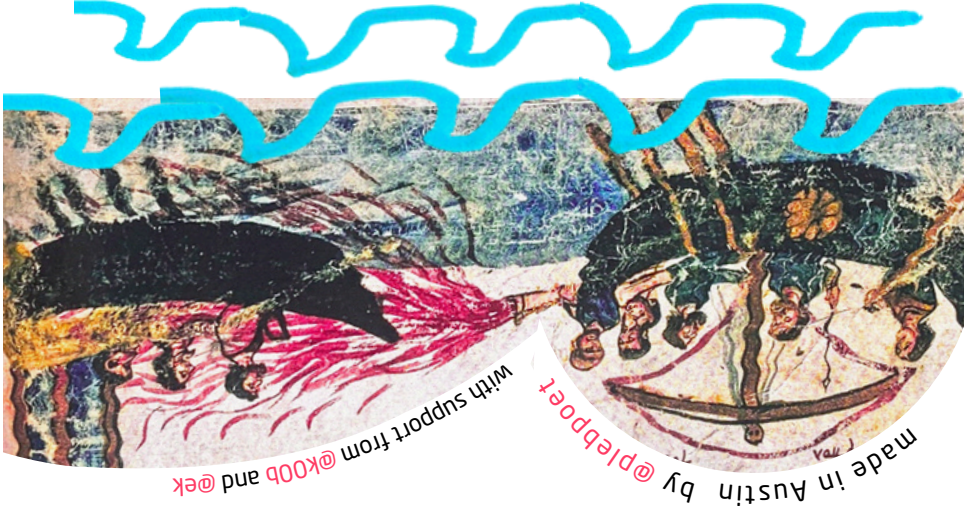
July 5 - July 11

ISSUE #16

Note from the Editor

Maybe it's price action that's getting you down, or perhaps it's stackers downzapping your posts, but everyone, now and then, takes a dip. The trick is not to let it sink you.

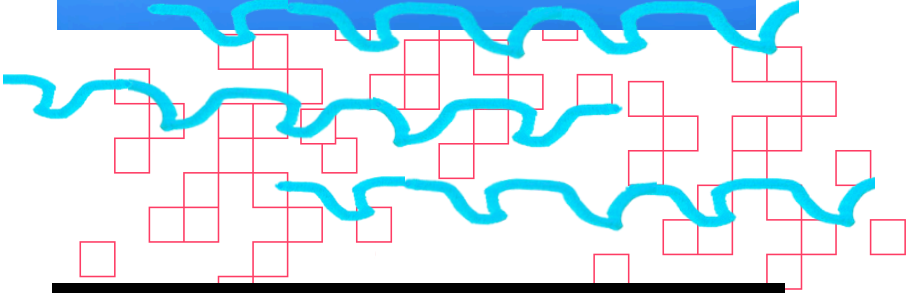
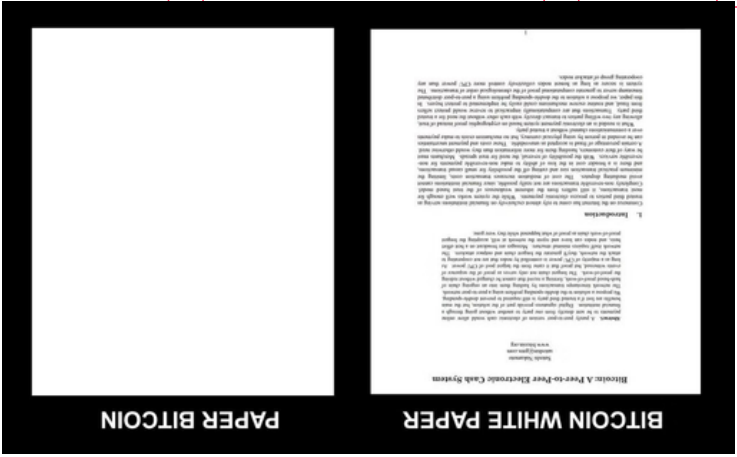
| id      | title                                                                      | weightedDownVotes | sats  |
|---------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|-------|
| 262,336 | Virology is a complete scam                                                | 7.5               | 5,999 |
| 985,880 | Wallet-stealer malware on macOS: here's what I built to solve it           | 6.73              | 4,340 |
| 782,412 | Earning 0.1 bitcoin by only clicking buttons.                              | 5.87              | 0     |
| 313,090 | Feature request: Stop the dex leak that for years identifies your users    | 5.84              | 271   |
| 464,529 | Did SpaceX's YouTube get hacked? (Looks like a Bitcoin scam)               | 5.34              | 140   |
| 335,917 | I did it. I sold investment properties to buy BTC                          | 5.24              | 3,064 |
| 829,853 | "Look at My Horse, My Horse Is Amazing."—On Custody, Tech, and SN's Future | 5.22              | 1,934 |
| 511,939 | Clean the Blockchain: Stop The Outlook, Hackers - Bitcoin Viro             | 5.12              | 0     |
| 510,804 | Bitcoin Classic: Bitcoin Daily 500 Plus Pairs Lists                        | 5.12              | 0     |
| 498,227 | Which cosplay is better?                                                   | 5.11              | 1,402 |



# Meme Monday - Best Bitcoin Meme Gets 5,000 CCs

268 sats \ 25 comments \ @sn 7 Jul memes bot #1026614

5042 sats \ 0 replies \ @hasherstacker 7 Jul



21 sats \ 0 comments \  
@SeeCyprius 14 Mar  
Photography #913230

## My Old Friend

17.4k sats \ 23 comments \ @siggy47 16h alter\_native #1032205

His dad drove a delivery truck for the Philadelphia Enquirer newspaper. He was a proud teamster who loved Mayor Rizzo. My friend inherited that strong love of labor unions. His family were all loyal democrats.

He had a strong Irish Catholic upbringing. He spend two years of high school in a seminary, but dropped out once he discovered girls.

He was a hoarder. He was always taking notes on scraps of paper, and he considered them all important. He had thousands of books crammed into his one bedroom apartment. We named it "The largest unread library in the world."

He claimed to despise waste, so he recycled stuff he found on the street by bringing it into his apartment. The piles would remain there, untouched, for years. He thought of all the uses people would have for his possessions after he died. When that day came, his landlady dumped them all in a landfill after his family and friends chose the few items they wanted.

We met as freshman at college. We were lucky to have been placed on a dorm floor with a special group of guys. Despite our different backgrounds and interests, we have maintained those friendships for more than fifty years. Some of us were more serious about their studies than others. He and I majored in fun, like many of our 1970s, post hippie generation. We had a large friend group during our college years. There was always something to do rather than focus on school. I did just enough to get by. He didn't.

He never got his degree. He couldn't be bothered to take 6 more credits, even when offered six years to do so. Instead, he committed his life to the natural food and supplement industry, and he also was an activist for Native American causes. Thunderheart was his all time favorite movie. Once I was compelled to watch it with him and his girlfriend, and I fell asleep halfway through. I don't think he ever forgave me.

During those years the two of us, either alone or with others, drove across the United States four times. We visited every state in the continental U.S. except for North Dakota. In later life we planned to check that one off the list by flying there, and then renting a car to cross the Canadian border. We would celebrate by attending a Winnipeg Jets game. We never managed to follow through with that plan.



keep reading from @siggy47

## The True and Accurate History of the Boating Accident Meme

23.1k sats \ 28 comments \ @Scoresby 30 Jan bitcoin #869881

...more than a hundred years ago, people could feel the cult of safety building walls around them. The *Titanic* famously marked a new era in nautical engineering, safe even from sinking. So it's not surprising that there was a note of relief when her sinking reassured the world that boating accidents were indeed still possible.



Although it is likely that the meme was circulating in society before Titanic's infamous voyage, it was the sinking of that ship that brought having a boating accident out into the popular discourse. . .

## How To Get Wrecked Trading Bitcoin

111 sats \ 0 comments \ @TheBTCManual 20 Dec 2022 bitcoin #109843

Top Boost

## Plebfi is back in Miami, July 26-27!

2485 sats \ 10k boost \ 0 comments \ @02a0613802 8 Jul events #1028384

Pleb.fi is back baby! And the theme this time around is...METAPROTOCOLS!



# Flounder Mode

6955 sats \ 5 comments \ @k00b 5 Jul mostly\_harmless #1023403

this article references this essay:

Kevin Kelly on a different way to do great work

By Brië Wolfson

June 2025



In this territory, we've had many conversations about depth vs breadth in career path. Kevin Kelly is non-binary in this regard - he tends to go deep enough and on many things. His interviewer is the same, serially accomplished, with so many medium-sized achievements they can't be worn like a crown even if they deserve one.

I started to take pride in this 'cool girl' approach to work. I joked about having never been promoted, but could feel my scope, impact, and relationships with colleagues growing. I remember rejecting a (well-meaning) manager's suggestion to build out a five-year career plan. I scoffed at people who cared about titles, did things for money, and had professional headshots on their LinkedIn.

And then, I'm not sure when the switch flipped, but I started to have a sinking feeling that I had it all wrong the whole time. I looked around and felt I was being outpaced by my colleagues—specifically by the MBAs and the people who chased titles, promotions, money, and building teams. And it wasn't just a vanity thing. They genuinely seemed to be focused on bigger, more interesting problems. And they were having more impact. They were mentoring young talent, influencing top lines and bottom lines, and had their fingerprints on all kinds of cool industry-recognized work.



I think most of the conflict stems from simple, singular achievements being easier to recognize than complex, nuanced ones. Easier for yourself to recognize too. Being very valuable yet unrecognized is so hard to make peace with. Kevin Kelly would say it's good to have an "illegible" career path—it means you're onto interesting stuff.

"I don't really pursue a destination," he said. "I pursue a direction."

## Why Bitcoin matters

One detail that I've glossed over so far is that it's not just the option to self-custody that matters, it's also how costly the option is. If self-custody is too costly or too difficult, then the constraining force it has on the behavior of custodians is lessened because the threat of self-custody is not credible. But the amazing thing about Bitcoin is that it *does* make the option of self-custody much more viable than any previous form of fiat or commodity money. Physical cash is difficult to secure in large amounts, and commodity money is both difficult to secure and hard to transport, and any form of digital cash which is easy to secure and easy to transport must be managed through a custodian. Bitcoin, on the other hand, is easy to secure, easy to transport, all while maintaining self-custody. You just need a few hours learning curve to learn how to use it.

## The future of self-custody?



Yet, a learning curve is still a learning curve, and I'm sure we all know plenty of people for whom a few hours of sustained attention is too much. What does that mean for Bitcoin and the future of self custody? Personally, I don't think self-custody will ever be mainstream. There are too many people for whom the learning curve is too steep, or who are too irresponsible for self-custody to be a good recommendation. And besides, if most custodians are behaving in a trustworthy manner, there wouldn't be much need for self-custody anyway.

But even if self-custody is not mainstream, the option to self-custody will remain important as a disciplining force on the market. The *option* of self-custody may be exactly the driving force that's needed to keep custodians honest. But in order for the option value of self-custody to matter, self-custody needs to be relatively inexpensive and uncomplicated. It doesn't need to be so convenient that everyone uses it, but it needs to be convenient enough that there's a credible threat that people will switch to it if no good custodians are available. It's therefore still important for Bitcoin developers to keep working on self-custodial solutions, even if there is little actualized demand.

**tl;dr** Game theory teaches us that having an option can shape the course of events, even if that option is never actually chosen. Similarly, the option to self-custody can shape the behavior of custodians---even if few people choose to self-custody. However, the impact of an option is strongest when the cost of choosing that option is low. Bitcoin devs should therefore continue working on improving self-custodial solutions.

## How the option for self-custody matters

Just like how the threat of entry matters more than actual entry in the Stackelberg Model, we can envision a model in which the option to self-custody matters more than its actual usage.

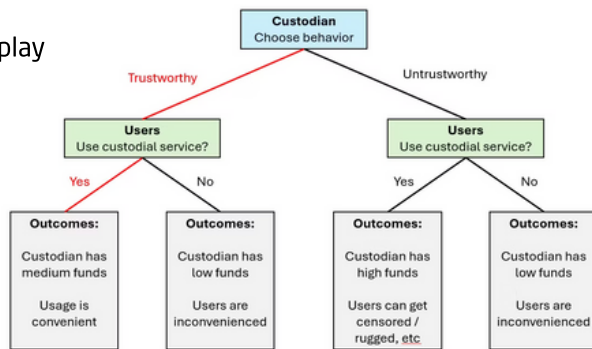
Imagine a game in which a custodian of funds (a bank, a wallet, etc) can either behave well or behave badly. Bad behavior could include any number of actions, like rug pulling, censoring users, selling data, or having bad security practices.

The custodian chooses good or bad behavior, and then users decide to either use the custodian or to self-custody. Self-custody is less convenient than using the custodian, but users prefer to self-custody if the custodian is going to behave badly.

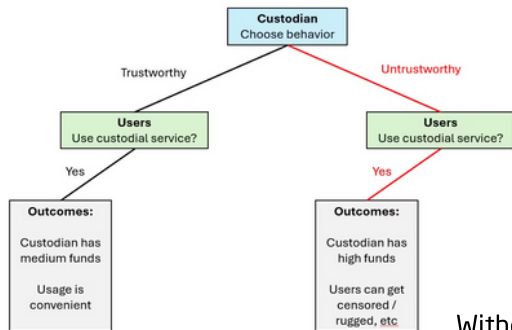
The game tree and path of play looks like this:



In this game, the option to self-custody constrains the custodian's behavior and forces it into good behavior. What if there was no option to self-custody?

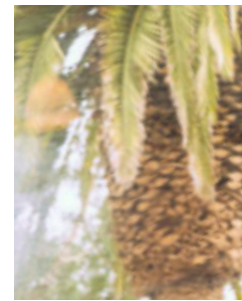


Then the game tree and path of play would look like this:



Without the option to self-custody, there is less constraint on the custodian's behavior. Because users have no other options, they are forced to use the custodian, and thus the custodian has no incentive to respect the users' privacy or to resist government requests for censorship.

Kelly's version of doing his life's work seems so joyful, so buoyant. So much less ... angsty. There's no suffering or ego. It's not about finding a hole in the mark or a path to global



domination. The yard stick isn't based on net worth or shareholder value or number of users or employees.

It's based on an internal satisfaction meter, but not in a self-indulgent way. He certainly seeks resonance and wants to make an impact, but more in the way of a teacher. He breathes life

into products or ideas, not out of a desire to win, but out of a desire to advance our collective thinking or action. His work and its impact unfold slowly, rather than by sheer force of will. Ideas or projects seem to tug at him, rather than reveal themselves on the other end of an internal cattle prod. His range is wide, but all his work somehow rhymes.

Kevin Kelly has made peace with it. And maybe that's the thing he'll be recognized most for.

I thought I was here to go deep on working Hollywood style, but as I sat there with Kelly in a room of what are best described as his toys, I realized that the most interesting thing about him is that he seems happy. At ease in the world and in his skin. I wasn't there with Kelly for permission to work Hollywood style. I was there for permission to work with both ambition and joy.

reply \ 754 sats \ 0 replies \ @elvism Mercury 5 Jul

I can't remember if it's ever come up how a big newish thing is what smart people expect their jobs to do for them - so much more than pay a living wage. Friends, meaning, status - the last is especially a bitch - all tied up in jobs. It's so fucking dumb.

If you have a marriage where you need your spouse to be your everything, that is a dead marriage walking. It will ruin almost everyone. And yet our culture has largely made it the default belief about career, for a certain breed of well-educated white-collar types. We've made a god of it, built an implicit infrastructure of worship around it. It's hard to think of something more poisonous that people don't taste as poison.

I'm now at the beginning of the fiendishly difficult endeavor of untangling all this. It's so fucking hard in ways I wouldn't have imagined when I was a newb. Maybe bc when you start out you swim up the gradient of more and it's progress you can feel. Once you get enough more that stops working. At least it has in my case.

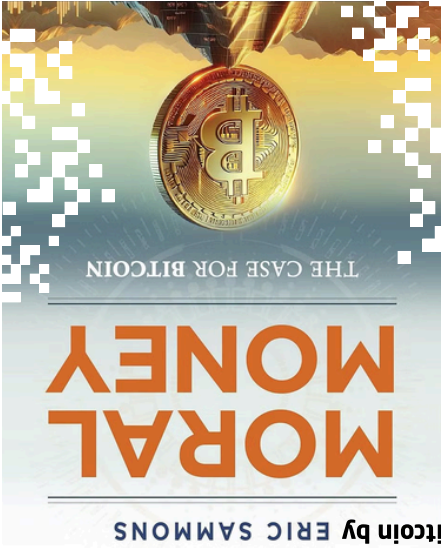
I've always admired KK bc he seems to have become maximally himself, and with a bit of attention - not too much, it seems like - bent a working life around his own nature, and not the reverse. Not everyone has the privilege of being able to pull that off, but I think many could. Many who are reading this can. It gives me hope.

# Moral Money: The Case for Bitcoin | Book

## Review

5254 sats \ 11 comments \ @SimpleStacker 7 Jul BooksAndArticles #1026822

Book review for Moral Money: The Case for Bitcoin by ERIC SAMMONS

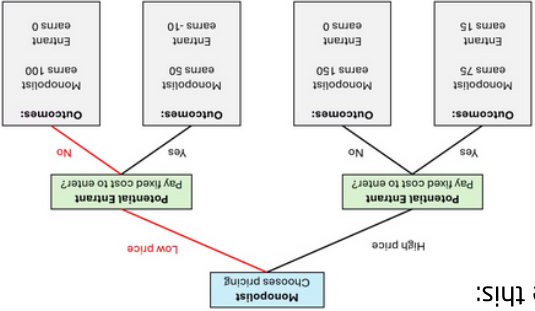


Ok, this will be a short review because for an experienced Bitcoiner, there isn't too much to say. This is a good book. In my opinion, it takes the correct approach to orange pilling. It starts with the why of Bitcoin---and not from the perspective of why Bitcoin is good for you as an individual, but why Bitcoin is good for society. By doing so, Sammons elevates the conversation beyond simplistic number-go-up thinking---which many critics think is the only purpose of Bitcoin--and directs the reader to the sound money principles that motivate the Bitcoin community. Although Sammons approaches Bitcoin from an explicitly Roman Catholic perspective, the moral principles he focuses on should be agreeable to most faith traditions and secular systems of ethics. For example, he says that a money is immoral if a small group of people can control it for their own benefit at the expense of others. Who would disagree with that?

**Eight principles of moral money**  
The book is a highly organized and logical introduction to why Bitcoin is a morally superior form of money. Chapter 1 starts by laying out eight moral principles that good money should satisfy:

1. Theft of someone's purchasing power is always condemned
2. We have a right to the fruits of our labor
3. Workers should receive a just wage
4. Economies should have a stable currency
5. Temperance should be encouraged
6. Excessive consumption should be discouraged
7. Parents must be able to provide for their families
8. Societies should care for the poor

And the path of play looks like this:



What happens is that the monopolist knows that if sets a high prices (anti-consumer), that will invite entry by the competitor. But if it sets a low price (pro-consumer), then the competitor won't enter because it wouldn't be worth the upfront cost.

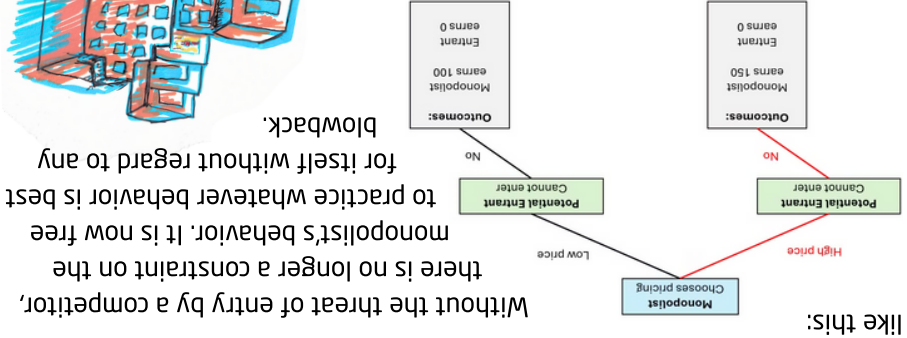
In the actual path of play, the monopolist sets a low price to deter entry, and the competitor never actually enters the market. What we then observe in real life is that the monopolist behaves somewhat competitively, even though there's no visible competition. We can say that the monopolist's pricing behavior is constrained by the threat of entry, even if entry never actually happens.

The Stackelberg Model shows that even though a company might appear to have a dominant market position (like Amazon in e-commerce) it may not actually have that much room to behave anti-competitively. The threat of competition keeps it honest. Amazon does, in fact, make this argument as to why its dominant market position doesn't actually lead to anti-consumer behavior.

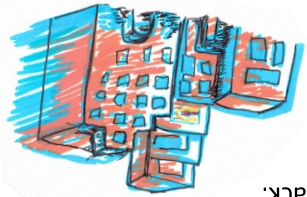
### The importance of option value

Even though the competitor doesn't actually enter the market in the Stackelberg Model, the option to enter is still very important in shaping the market outcome.

To see this, let's imagine what would happen if there was no possibility for entry by a competitor. The game tree and path of play would end up looking like this:



Without the threat of entry by a competitor, there is no longer a constraint on the monopolist's behavior. It is now free to practice whatever behavior is best for itself without regard to any blowback.

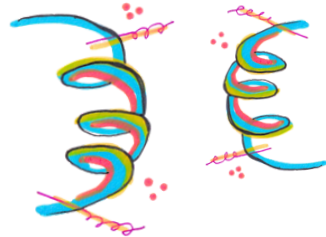


# Pleb Economist #8: What game theory can teach us about Bitcoin and self-custody

19.6k sats \ 9 comments \ @SimpleStacker 9 Jul econ #1030571

## The Pleb Economist #8: What game theory can teach us about Bitcoin and self-custody

- Introduction
- The Stackelberg Model
- The importance of option value
- How the option for self-custody matters
- Why Bitcoin matters
- The future of self-custody?
- tl;dr



### Introduction

There's been a lot of discussion recently about self-custody ([#1020261](#), [#1030290](#)). While most Bitcoiners espouse the virtues of self-custody, others have questioned whether there's any real demand for it, and whether self-custody will ever become a mainstream option ([#679850](#)).

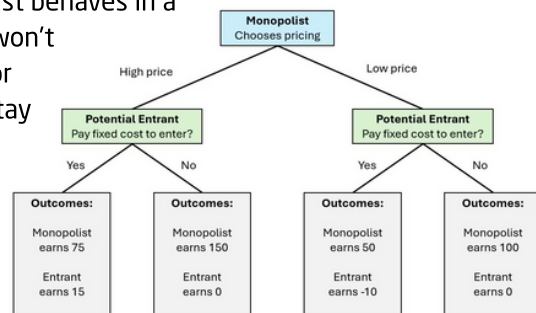
Yet, something that I've occasionally thought about is that having the option of self-custody can be just as important as actually using it ([#783976](#)). How can that be? Today we'll take a look at some game theory to help us answer that question.

### The Stackelberg Model

We'll start by looking at the Stackelberg Model. This is a model that illustrates how the threat of entry by a potential competitor can be enough to deter a monopolist from the worst anti-consumer behaviors, even if the potential competitor never actually enters the market.

The idea is pretty simple: if the monopolist behaves badly, then this gives more space for a competitor to enter the market, which in the long run hurts the monopolist. But if the monopolist behaves in a more pro-consumer manner, it won't leave any space for a competitor to enter---and thus, it gets to stay as a monopolist, which earns more profit in the long run.

Formally, the game tree looks something like this:



Most people would find these principles broadly agreeable, though some may quibble with the definition of a "just wage" or "excessive consumption", or the extent to which the poor is society's responsibility. Still, social voting patterns suggest that these principles are not controversial and are held by a large majority of voters, both religious and secular.

### Seven properties of moral money

Chapter 2 goes on to list seven properties of money which would help satisfy the above moral principles:

1. Money should be divisible
2. Money should be portable
3. Money should be durable
4. Money should be fungible
5. Money should be verifiable
6. Money should be scarce
7. Money should be independent

Sammons connects these properties to the aforementioned eight moral principles. For example, he explains how money which is not scarce and not independent (e.g. money that can be printed) discourages temperance and encourages excessive consumption. This is because holders of the money cannot trust that the money won't be devalued in the future, and are thus incentivized to spend the money now. This is all pretty well-trod ground for Bitcoiners, but Sammons presents his arguments in a clear, logical manner that should be accessible even for people with little prior exposure to Bitcoin.

The rest of the book is devoted to comparing different systems of money: physical commodity money, fiat money, and Bitcoin, along the above properties. Spoiler alert: it is determined that commodity money fails on portability and to some degree scarcity and independence, whereas fiat money fails on verifiability, scarcity, and independence. By comparison, Bitcoin satisfies all seven properties. Again, this won't come as a surprise to anyone who's studied Bitcoin for a long time, but it may be eye opening for someone who hasn't.



## Addressing objections and assessing crypto

My two favorite chapters in the book are one that addresses objections to Bitcoin and the one that assesses other cryptocurrencies. The chapter on objections offers responses to many of the common criticisms of Bitcoin, such as how it's too volatile to be used as a money, its environmental impact, and its usage by criminals. The arguments that Sammons gives in response to these objections are all pretty standard, but it's good to have them all in one place for someone who wants to defend Bitcoin against its critics. It's also useful if you haven't seen some of these arguments before.

The chapter on cryptocurrency is helpful because Sammons is willing to steel-man the use case of some cryptos, while not being shy to label others as outright scams. Sammons classifies cryptos into the following categories: attempted forms of money, stablecoins, technology projects, memecoins/scams, and CBDs.

- Attempted forms of money
  - These include bitcoin spinoffs like Litecoin and DASH. These were attempted improvements to the Bitcoin protocol, but Sammons argues that Bitcoin's network effect will keep Bitcoin dominant.
  - Stablecoins
    - Sammons rightly labels these as (in the best case scenario) a payment layer on top of fiat. Stablecoins therefore can't be considered a different form of money than fiat. Of course, in the worst case scenario these could also be outright frauds.
    - Technology projects
      - This is where Sammons puts projects like Ethereum, which aim to be more than just sound money. Sammons offers some criticisms of proof of stake, but because he doesn't see these projects as attempts at money, he doesn't spend too much time on them.
      - Memecoins/scams
        - Sammons acknowledges that many crypto projects are simply get rich quick schemes where the creators of a coin have no interest other than running quick pump and dumps or having a laugh.
        - Central Bank Digital Currencies
          - Lastly, Sammons criticizes CBDs as even more immoral than traditional fiat, because they are even worse in terms of independence and scarcity. He highlights how the government will always be tempted to print more money, and if money is programmable, to even put a negative interest rate on the money so as to encourage profligate consumption.

## Conclusion

I found the chapter on cryptocurrencies to be especially important for Bitcoin novices who haven't yet learned to distinguish between the various types of crypto projects. Given that I think this book's intended audience are no-coiners and pre-coiners, this was a crucial chapter to include.

Overall, I don't think experienced Bitcoiners will learn too much that is new. The principles of sound money espoused in this book are frequently discussed in the Bitcoin community, and I imagine that most of the readers here on StackExchange are already quite familiar with them. What the book does best is to organize and communicate these principles in a logical, persuasive, and accessible manner. This is a book that you could consider gifting your pre-coin friends, especially if they have a Christian background.